



Dell Inspiron 1720

As You Like It

With the Inspiron 1720, Dell ups the ante in the super-performance notebook category. A 17-inch, the Inspiron 1720 is quite bulky, but the good design hides this.

You get to choose from eight colours for the lid—jet black and seven other satin finishes. The custom paint job, however, is modest, and will not last too long.

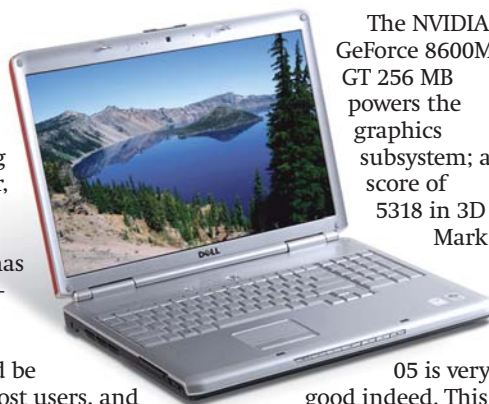
The 17-inch glossy widescreen (1920 x 1200) panel is beautiful; colour reproduction is vibrant, and it has a wide viewing angle.

The full-sized keyboard is a delight to type on—silent and great tactile response. The Matshita BD-RE UJ-220 Blu-ray drive means you won't need to upgrade the

optical drive in a long, long time! However, DVI as well as HDMI connectivity has been left out—criminal.

500 GB of storage should be enough for most users, and 4 GB of RAM is adequate for most applications, games, and for the bundled Microsoft Vista Home Premium.

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆



The NVIDIA GeForce 8600M GT 256 MB powers the graphics subsystem; a score of 5318 in 3D Mark

05 is very good indeed. This Inspiron churned out 96.4 fps and 65.31 fps in *Doom 3* and *FarCry* respectively at 800 x 600—decent for moderate gamers.

In terms of performance, the Dell Inspiron 1720 scores better than the *Digit Best Buy Gold* winner (the HP DV6226tx) in the Performance Laptops category of our July 2007 laptop test. The 85 Wh nine-

cell battery managed to power this beast for 2:48 hours in our tests.

The Inspiron 1720 can be configured at Dell's Web site. The base price for the Inspiron 1720 series starts from Rs 58,650—price varies according to the components you choose. The laptop carries a one-year warranty with the option of on-site support for up to three years.

Specifications

Intel Core 2 Duo T 7500 (2.2GHz); 17-inch widescreen XGA; NVIDIA GeForce 8600M GT 256MB; 500 GB SATA hard drive; 4 GB DDR2 667MHz RAM; 85 Wh battery pack

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Price: Rs 1,56,200

Mitashi DHD 911

Something good, something bad

DVD players' prices have rock-bottomed, and most brands offer similar feature sets. The Mitashi DHD 911, however, offers HDMI output. Hooking it up to the latest displays is uncomplicated. Looks-wise, it's plain.

The DVD tray is slim with blue LEDs. The front panel sports an MMC card reader along with a USB port. A gripe here—the navigation and playback keys are hard, with erratic responses. Build quality is below par—Mitashi uses cheap plastic and a thin case.

The player's file browser allows browsing the media disc (DVD / CD) along with USB drive and also the MMC card. Audio, video, and image files on the input media are listed separately by the file browser, making for fairly simple navigation.

On the audio output front, the player supports Dolby Digital AC-3 5.1, along with coaxial digital signal output. For video output, the player has a variety of options: component, composite S-Video, and HDMI. Hooking it up to AV equipment is trouble-free thanks to the

variety of output ports on the back panel.

We weren't able to play MPEG4 video files, and the input media source made no difference. It played our test DVDs and VCDs without any problems, though. The audio playback quality failed to impress, and the video playback quality was just about decent.

The infrared remote control is riddled with

(480p / 720p / 108i / 1080p upmixed) are available in the video section of the main menu.

This product gives you average value for money—DVD players with better playback quality are available at around the same price range. The only saving graces for the Mitashi DHD 911 are features like Flash media as input source and support for HDMI.

Specifications

DVD, SVCD, VCD, JPEG, MP3, WMA, MPEG4 playback support; USB slot; MMC card slot; 5.1-channel audio



RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

small buttons, and the layout is, overall, quite messy. It's menu layout is, however, clean, with control over basic and advanced features. Advanced settings like HDMI output resolution

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